Abdullah Al Zahid

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Hiring Manager
Survey Data Processing
Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation, Ottawa, ON

Re: Specialist, Geographic Information Systems (Requisition 12565)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Specialist, Geographic Information Systems position on the Survey Data Processing team. My background is in transportation planning, and the part of it that overlaps with your role is geospatial data: building it, checking it and making it usable for analysts.

At the City of Toronto I build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets that Transportation Planning depends on, including a right-of-way width dataset covering all city roads, built with QGIS, MapBox and JavaScript. I also built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which brought several years of survey data into one validated source the division reports from. I work in ArcGIS Pro and QGIS and write Python and SQL for the data work. I explain data to the people who use it through briefing notes and presentations.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not administered enterprise GIS licensing or ArcGIS Enterprise, and I have not worked with SAS or R. I have not managed vendors, set a data quality audit methodology, or estimated resources for a large project, and I have no experience with housing or market survey data. My experience is about four and a half years. The role would be in Ottawa and I am in Toronto, which I raise only so you have the full picture. I am applying because geospatial data work is the part of my experience I would most like to grow.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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